SARA AHARON

Geospatial Analyst

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PROFILE

Geospatial analyst with research experience in Earth Observation, specializing in cloud-based spatial analysis, remote sensing and environmental monitoring. Skilled in Google Earth Engine, QGIS and ArcGIS, applying Sentinel-2, Landsat and VIIRS nighttime lights data to urban expansion, green infrastructure dynamics and coastal geomorphology. Published at ECRS 2026 (MDPI), 2nd Prize at the "Mihai David" National Student Symposium, and presenter at the ASI-CEOS international workshop.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIC HONORS

B.Sc. in Territorial Planning — **Oct 2024 – Present**
Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași, Faculty of Geography and Geology | Iași, Romania
Academic Merit Scholarship Recipient (2024-2025 & 2025-2026)

- **1st Prize - Top Student:** Ranked 1st overall in Territorial Planning specialization (Year 1 & Year 2)

Academia RATIO XVI - Summer School — **Aug 2026 – Sept 2026**
Babeș-Bolyai University, Faculty of Economics and Business Administration | Cluj-Napoca, Romania

Erasmus+ BIP - Safe Mountain Explorer — **15-19 Jun 2026**
Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences | Wrocław, Poland

Just & Resilient Communities - Field Research Program — **16-23 May 2026**
Van Hall Larenstein Univ. (NL), ADR Nord-Est, & UAIC | Piatra Neamț, Romania

- Field research on community livelihoods to develop actionable policy recommendations for local authorities.

European Economic Studies — **Oct 2013 – Jun 2014**
Romanian-American University | Bucharest, Romania

RESEARCH PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

Cloud-Based Monitoring of 20 Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand — **Jun 2026 – Oct 2026**

PUBLICATION ORAL PRESENTATION

Publication: Aharon, S. (2026). Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand, Using Google Earth Engine and Multi-Temporal Satellite Imagery. *Proc. 6th Int. Electronic Conf. on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026)*, MDPI, Basel, Switzerland.

- Quantified 20 years of shoreline change across 21 transects: average retreat of 56 m (up to 117 m at the most affected transect), with 1.01 km² lost to erosion against 0.25 km² gained through accretion.

Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management POSTER PRESENTATION — **16 Sept 2026**
Italian Space Agency (ASI) & CEOS WGD International Workshop | Rome, Italy

- Developed and presented a scientific research poster on satellite Earth Observation techniques applied to disaster risk assessment and environmental monitoring.

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure - Focșani Municipality (1990-2025) — **20 Nov 2025**

2ND PRIZE WINNER ORAL PRESENTATION

"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed., UAIC Iași)

- Combined NDVI, NDBI, land surface temperature and population density (Sentinel-2, Landsat 8/9, GHS-POP) across Focșani and 10 neighboring localities. Built-up area grew 26.6% (1995-2025) while population fell 16.8%, peak NDVI dropped ~29% (2015-2024), and mean annual temperature rose ~2°C. Clustering identified 4 urban typologies.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager - Dead Freddies LLC June 2015 – Jan 2024
Ocean City, Maryland, United States
Directed daily operations of a 1,000+ seat hospitality venue, leading a multinational team of 200.

- Developed high-level leadership, crisis management, cross-cultural communication, and operational problem-solving capabilities.

CONFERENCES, SYMPOSIA & WORKSHOPS

International Geographic Seminar "Dimitrie Cantemir" (46th Ed.) - UAIC Iași		ORAL PRESENTATION	Oct 2026
The 6th International Electronic Conference on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026) - MDPI		ORAL PRESENTATION	Oct 2026
ASI-CEOS WGD Workshop on Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management - Italian Space Agency (ASI), Rome, Italy		POSTER PRESENTATION	Sept 2026
JUST4MPA Hands-on Conference: Blue Justice and Social Equity for Marine Protected Areas - University of Bucharest		PARTICIPANT	Jun 2026
National Conference "George Vâlsan" - Babeș-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca		ORAL PRESENTATION	May 2026
Annual Scientific Communications Session (31st Ed.) - University of Craiova		ORAL PRESENTATION	May 2026
Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop - ASI, DLR, ROSA & POLITEHNICA Bucharest		PARTICIPANT	Apr 2026
BACKUP GISRS International Symposium (Spring Ed., 32nd Ed.) - UAIC Iași		ORAL PRESENTATION	Mar 2026
National Symposium of Student Geographers (32nd Ed.) - CCMESI & Univ. of Bucharest		ORAL PRESENTATION	Mar 2026
geo-spatial.org Seminars (45th Ed.) - Chișinău, Republic of Moldova		ORAL PRESENTATION	Mar 2026
"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed.) - UAIC Iași	2ND PLACE WINNER	ORAL PRESENTATION	Nov 2025
TELLURIA International Youth Conference for Earth Sciences & Humanities (2nd Ed.) - UAIC Iași		ORAL PRESENTATION	Nov 2025
Climate Change Summit 2025 - Palace of Parliament, Bucharest		PARTICIPANT	Oct 2025

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate - Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & Union of Romanian Students | Bucharest, Romania

- Collaborated with student delegates from Romania and the diaspora to draft consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration.

Environmental Fieldwork & Documentary Contributor - V.O.T.C.A. Project Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & ETH Student League | Vatra Dornei, Suceava, Romania

- Participated in mountain environmental field evaluations and documentary film production (*Vreau O Țară Ca Afară*, 2025) assessing ecological conditions and community impact.

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide - ARC Camps **Aug 2024**

Department for Romanians Everywhere (Government of Romania) | Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania

- Guided and mentored 50 youth from the Romanian diaspora in Ukraine and Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program focused on heritage and identity reconnection.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

GIS & Remote Sensing:	QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST, Aerial/UAV Imagery
Data & Development:	Python, SQL, VS Code, HTML, CSS, GitHub Pages, Geospatial Data Analysis
Soft Skills:	Research Analysis, Leadership, Teamwork
Language Proficiency:	Romanian: Native | English: C1 (Fluent) | Spanish: Intermediate | German: Beginner

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

GIS, Remote Sensing & Cartography

- ESRI: GIS for Climate Action (Mar 2026)
- ESRI: Going Places with Spatial Analysis (Feb 2026)
- ESRI: GIS Basics (Feb 2026)
- ESRI: The ArcGIS Imagery MOOC: Foundations and Frontiers (Nov 2025)
- ESRI: Cartography (Oct 2025)
- ESRI: Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps (May 2025)
- NASA: Fundamentals of Remote Sensing (Nov 2025)

Data, AI & Open Science

- Esri on AWS: The Rise of GeoAI (Feb 2026)
- NASA: NASA Open Science 101 (Feb 2026)
- NASA: NASA Open Science Essentials (Feb 2026)
- AWS: Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence (Jan 2026)
- Google Cloud Training: Intro to Generative AI (Jan 2026)
- HP Foundation: Data Science & Analytics (May 2025)

Aviation & Technical Qualifications

- EASA: A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot License (Valid to Dec 2030)
- ICDL/ECDL Romania: IT Skills Certification (Jan 2010)

Climate, Nature & Conservation

- IUCN Academy: Synthetic Biology in Relation to Nature Conservation (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Introduction to Mapping Biodiversity Priorities (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Introduction to Finance for Nature (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Introduction to Conservation and Agriculture (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Introduction to Cities and Nature (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Introduction to Conservation and Climate Change (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: United for Nature and Society (Aug 2026)
- IUCN Academy: Nature's Crown Jewels: An Introduction to Nature World Heritage (Aug 2026)
- RECOFTC: Community Forestry 101 (Jul 2026)
- HP Foundation: Circular Economy (May 2025)